

THE SESSION · POST-CLOSE READ

Barrels Over Bandwidth

The index finished within a whisper of unchanged, but underneath it capital moved decisively out of semiconductors and into energy. The Dividend Strategy took the day; the Growth Portfolio finished essentially level with its benchmark.

S&P 500 ▼ 0.06%

NASDAQ ▼ 0.32%

DOW ▼ 0.11%

VIX 15.41

BRENT ▲ \$88

DIVIDEND STRATEGY

▲ BEAT DVY + SPY

+0.22%

1-DAY

FCI		+0.22%
DVY		+0.05%
SPY		-0.02%

YTD +22.84% vs DVY +16.57% · SPY +13.96%

GROWTH PORTFOLIO

▼ LEVEL WITH IUSG

-0.24%

1-DAY

FCI		-0.24%
IUSG		-0.23%

YTD +20.14% vs IUSG +15.64%

THE SESSION

A quiet index masked an unusually decisive session underneath it. The S&P 500 closed at 7,753.15, lower by 0.06%; the Dow eased 0.11% and the Nasdaq 0.32%. Those figures describe almost nothing about what actually happened. The energy sector rose better than four percent as crude repriced hard on doubt that the Strait of Hormuz reopens on any near-term schedule — West Texas Intermediate settled near \$82 and Brent near \$88, each roughly five percent higher. Advancing and declining issues split close to evenly, with the majority of names lower. What looked like a flat tape was a rotation running at full speed beneath a still surface.

The morning framework held up well. The weekend's refinery strike in southwestern Saudi Arabia and Tehran's published list of preconditions were always going to matter more to the crude curve than to the equity index, and that is exactly how the day resolved: the oil complex did the repricing and equities absorbed it without much complaint. The 10-year Treasury yield added roughly four basis points to about 4.70% as the energy move fed straight into inflation expectations, with July CPI due Wednesday morning and September policy odds sitting near a coin flip. Gold advanced 1.17% to \$4,451. The VIX finished at 15.41 — still a compressed reading for a tape carrying this much geopolitical variable.

Days like this are why we hold two sleeves rather than one. The rotation that cost us in silicon paid us in barrels, and the owner of both simply had an ordinary Monday.

The Dividend Strategy gained 0.22%, ahead of DVY at +0.05% and SPY at -0.02%, carried by defense, ag inputs and steel. The Growth Portfolio eased 0.24% against IUSG at -0.23% — effectively a matched session, and a good outcome given the sleeve's semiconductor weighting on a day when that group was the funding source for everything else. Chevron, ONEOK and CNX did the offsetting work. Digital assets

stayed heavy: bitcoin near \$63,985, with IBIT lower by 1.55% and ETHA by 2.28%. Year to date the Dividend Strategy stands at +22.84% against DVY's +16.57%, and the Growth Portfolio at +20.14% against IUSG's +15.64%. Both leads were built on sessions that looked considerably less eventful than this one.

FCI HOLDINGS · NOTABLE MOVERS

WINNERS

OKE +4.54%

GROWTH

Midstream re-rated with the crude complex; toll-model cash flows leveraged to renewed Hormuz uncertainty.

CVX +4.48%

GROWTH

Integrated majors led the S&P 500 energy sector higher as WTI settled near \$82 and Brent near \$88.

NTR +2.93%

DIVIDEND

Ag inputs bid on the gas-cost and crop-cycle argument following the Q2 potash volume guidance raise.

DECLINERS

MARA -5.25%

GROWTH

Miners moved lower with bitcoin near \$64,000; the 10-Q detailed 23,093 BTC sold in the first half.

MRVL -4.62%

GROWTH

Second-tier AI silicon gave back ground as the day's bid moved out of semiconductors and into barrels.

CRDO -3.98%

GROWTH

High-multiple AI networking traded with the group; no company-specific news accompanied the move.

LMT +2.59%

DIVIDEND

Defense primes gained on a widening geopolitical risk premium and fresh Department of Defense contract news.

STLD +2.34%

DIVIDEND

Steel and hard assets caught the same rotation that lifted gold, with aluminum ramp still ahead of it.

QCOM -3.39%

DIVIDEND

Handset margin pressure and reduced Apple modem share continue to weigh following the July guide.

NVDA -2.87%

GROWTH

Reports of a \$500 billion AI infrastructure financing arrangement with Wall Street partners drew scrutiny.

HOLDINGS NEWS

MARA details first-half bitcoin sales. The company's quarterly filing disclosed 23,093 bitcoin sold during the first half of 2026 at an average near \$70,631, leaving roughly 35,577 coins on the balance sheet at quarter end. Management has moved from a strict-retention policy to funding operations, acquisitions and its AI and energy-infrastructure buildout from the treasury. Shares finished lower by 5.25% alongside the broader mining group.

Nvidia tied to a large AI infrastructure financing. Reports that the company is participating in a roughly \$500 billion AI infrastructure financing arrangement alongside major Wall Street institutions drew a mixed reception, with shares closing lower by 2.87%. The structure of AI capital commitments — who funds them and on what terms — is becoming as central to the thesis as the chips themselves.

YEAR-TO-DATE STANDING

DIVIDEND STRATEGY

+22.84%

vs DVY +16.57% / SPY +13.96%

GROWTH PORTFOLIO

+20.14%

vs IUSG +15.64%